

Offalia's Attack

The Blue Water Inn, midnight · Session Prep IV, Scene 5 · 4,500 XP — High for four level 5 characters plus Ireena

OFFALIA — NIGHT HAG

Medium Fiend, Neutral Evil · CR 5 (1,800 XP) · 2024 Monster Manual

AC 17 · **Init** +5 (15) · **HP** 112 (15d8+45) · **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 +4	15 +2	16 +3	16 +3	14 +2	16 +3

Skills Deception +6, Insight +5, Perception +5, Stealth +5 · **Resist** Cold, Fire · **Immune** Charmed · Darkvision 120 ft., PP 15

Magic Resistance. Advantage on saves against spells and magical effects.

Soul Bag. AC 15, HP 20, Resistance to all damage. Destroy it and the souls go free.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Two Claws. **Claw**. +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 13 (2d8+4) Slashing.

Nightmare Haunting (1/day, needs her soul bag; an Action, but Dream takes 1 minute to cast, so never mid-fight). From the Ethereal, she casts Dream on a sleeper she can see; the Psychic damage also lowers their HP maximum. That's what "sweet dreams" means.

Spellcasting (Int, DC 14). *At will*: Detect Magic, Etherealness, Magic Missile (level 4: six darts, 1d4+1 each, about 21). *2/day each*: Phantasmal Killer, Plane Shift (self only).

BONUS ACTION

Shape-Shift. Humanoid form (the old woman) or true form.

Table rules (Prep IV): she goes Ethereal only with a heartstone in her hand (she holds her own). She doesn't Plane Shift: it can't take her out of Barovia. She drops the **Eyes of Deceit** below 80 HP. She leaves below 56 HP, once she has Morgantha's heartstone, or at the end of round 5.

HP — each box 4 · shaded boxes: 80 and 56

BANDERHOBB

Large Monstrosity · CR 5 (1,800 XP) · Monsters of the Multiverse

AC 15 · **HP** 84 (8d10+40) · **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 +5	12 +1	20 +5	11 +0	14 +2	8 –1

Skills Athletics +8, Stealth +7 · **Immune** Charmed, Frightened · Darkvision 120 ft., PP 12

Resonant Connection. With a scrap of someone (a hair, a thread), it knows the way to them within 1 mile.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. One Bite and one Tongue; it can swap one for Shadow Step.

Bite. +8, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 15 (3d6+5) Piercing; Large or smaller is **Grappled** (escape DC 16) and Restrained while grappled, and it can't Bite or Tongue anyone else.

Tongue. +8, reach 15 ft. *Hit*: 10 (3d6) Necrotic; DC 16 Str save or pulled to within 5 ft.

Shadow Step. Teleports up to 30 ft. into dim light or darkness it can see.

Swallow. +8 against a Medium or smaller creature it's grappling. *Hit*: 15 (3d6+5) Piercing and swallowed: Blinded, Restrained, total cover, 10 (3d6) Necrotic at the start of each of its turns. At 0 HP the victim stops taking damage and is stable. One at a time. It spits them out (Prone) if it dies, or whenever it chooses.

BONUS ACTION

Shadow Stealth. Hides while in dim light or darkness.

Table rules (Prep IV): bright light around it (a torch in its face, *Daylight*) leaves it nowhere to Shadow Step. If it takes 20 or more damage in one turn, it coughs up what it swallowed.

HP — each box 4

SWARM OF GREMISHKAS ×2

Medium swarm of Tiny Monstrosities, Chaotic Evil · CR 2 (450 XP) each · Ravenloft: The Horrors Within

AC 14 · **HP** 31 (7d4+14) · **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 +1	14 +2	15 +2	11 +0	14 +2	4 –3

Resist Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing · **Immune** Charmed, Frightened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Prone, Restrained, Stunned · Darkvision 30 ft., PP 12

Magic Resistance. Advantage on saves against spells and magical effects.

Swarm. Shares spaces; moves through Tiny gaps; can't heal or gain temp HP.

Swarming Bites. +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 12 (3d6+2) Piercing, or 9 (3d4+2) while Bloodied, **plus** 7 (2d6) Force. **The target's attunement to one magic item ends** (your choice).

Swarm A (kitchen) — 31 HP · shaded: Bloodied

Swarm B (stable) — 31 HP · shaded: Bloodied

ANIMATED BROOM (OFFALIA'S DANCING BROOM)

Small Construct · CR 1/4 (50 XP) · 2024 Monster Manual. **AC** 15 · **HP** 14 (4d6) · **Speed** 5 ft., fly 50 ft. (hover) · **Init** +5. Immune Poison, Psychic; Charmed, Deafened, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned. Blindsight 60 ft. **Flyby**. No Opportunity Attacks when it flies out of reach. **Slam**. +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 5 (1d4+3) Bludgeoning. Offalia animates it with a Magic action; it acts right after her. At 0 HP it shatters.

Broom — each box 2

RND	THE FIRE	OFFALIA	BANDERHOBB	GREMISHKAS & OTHERS
1	Lamp oil spills in the kitchen. Orange light under the floorboards.	"Wakey wakey, dearie. You've got something of Mummy's." Phantasmal Killer on whoever stands between the banderhobb and Ireena, usually Barry.	Stands up out of the corner's shadow. Tongue Ireena's ankle (DC 16 Str) and pull; Bite to grab her.	Kitchen swarm starts the fire. Stable swarm goes for Costakis, who screams.
2	Kitchen burning. Smoke under the doors.	Goes for the heartstone: her Athletics or Sleight of Hand against the carrier's Athletics or Acrobatics, or Magic Missile at anyone freeing Ireena.	Swallow Ireena (its whole action), then walks to the dark stairwell. No Ireena? It takes the heartstone carrier.	Swarms whoever comes downstairs. Danika on the landing: " <i>Brom. Bray. Hold my hands.</i> "
3	Stable burning. Rictavio's wagon catches; something inside roars.	Two Claws if cornered. With the heartstone in hand: Etherealness on her next turn.	Shadow Step into the stairwell's dark, then out through the landing window. Chase: the yard .	Rictavio , in his nightshirt: one hand crossbow bolt at the banderhobb, +5, 1d6+2 piercing + 2d4 radiant. " <i>Get a light on it!</i> "
4	Stairs full of smoke: Heavily Obscured.	Losing? She throws down the broom , which animates.	Chase: the town wall , climbing like a frog on glass.	The ravens , once, if the party is losing: Advantage on one attack, or Disadvantage on one of Offalia's rolls.
5	The whole ground floor . Glass bursts.	End of round 5 at the latest: " <i>Sweet dreams, dearies. Every one of you.</i> " She goes Ethereal.	Over the wall and gone . If it has Ireena, next session is a rescue.	The swarms scatter into the walls.

BEFORE IT STARTS

Ask: **where is everyone sleeping, who's on watch, who has the heartstone and the soul bag?**

Perception DC 14 (DC 10 on watch) for anyone awake who didn't eat a pastry: *the inn has gone silent; the candle leans away from the darkest corner*. Fail = **Surprised**: Disadvantage on Initiative. Anyone using the **Hag Eye** acts first.

Ethradir can't be put to sleep (Trance) and stays aware: he rolls as on watch. Fedra's raven counts as on watch and can peck one sleeper awake as its action.

Sleepers are Unconscious. Nobody attacks one on purpose; a hit wakes them and isn't a crit.

Revivify: 450 gp of diamonds = **one** casting (300 gp), within 1 minute of a death. Half the party ate pastries, or no long rest since Bonegrinder? Remove one swarm.

INITIATIVE

1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10

HOW IT ENDS

To stop Offalia escaping: knock the heartstone out of her hand, or keep her Incapacitated. Grappling her works too (table rule).

If she dies: she turns back into her true form on the floor. Heartstone, soul bag, broom, a pouch of Dream Pastries, 15 gp. Bella is the last sister.

Bargain: "*The heart and the bag, and the girl comes back up out of my pet. Tonight.*" She keeps her word, for tonight.

Most likely: Offalia escapes, Ireena is saved, and the inn burns. Ethradir hears where Bella went: "*Miranda, isn't it? Bella's going to tuck her in.*"

XP: 4,500, shared (+50 if the broom animates and is destroyed).